ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 8: **The Gupta Era** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** it describes Samudragupta's conquests and ideals	Inscription
2	**(b)** decimal place value and zero	Indian numerals
3	**(d)** claim to supreme power over smaller rulers	Imperial pride
4	**(d)** it praises the king and may exaggerate	Source criticism
5	**(b)** astronomy, weather, plants and architecture	Encyclopedic
6	**(b)** royal patronage of rock-cut art	Gupta period
7	**(b)** had advanced knowledge of iron	Technology
8	**(d)** they show the heights of Sanskrit literature	Classical literature
9	**(a)** to create lasting structures	Development of temples
10	**(a)** Gupta India enjoyed peace and prosperity	Observation

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Prosperity (1); Achievements (1).	1+1
12	Rustless (1); Advanced metallurgy (1).	1+1
13	Hunas (1); Weak rulers (1).	1+1
14	Conquests recorded (1); Ideals of kingship (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Inscriptions (1); Coins (1); Literature (1).	1+1+1
16	Prabhavati (1); Queens (1); Education (1).	1+1+1
17	Iron pillar (1); Bronze statues (1); Coins (1).	1+1+1
	OR: King (1); Provinces (1); Local rulers (1).	1+1+1
18	Plays (1); Poems (1); Themes (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Subjects (1); Scholars (1); Patronage (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Politics (1); Economy (1); Literature (1); Science (1); Art (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Vakatakas (1); Pallavas (1); Kamarupa (1); Alliances (1); Culture (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Chandragupta I (1); Samudragupta (1); Chandragupta II (1); Skandagupta (1); Decline (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Hunas (1); Economy (1); Feudatories (1); Succession (1); End (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing the Prayaga Prashasti as Kalidasa's work; it was composed by **Harisena** for **Samudragupta**.
- Saying the Iron Pillar of Delhi is made of stainless steel; it is iron that resists rust because of a thin **protective surface layer**.
- Confusing travellers: **Faxian** (Chinese, Chandragupta II's time) is not **Megasthenes** (Greek, Mauryan court).
- Mixing authors and books: **Aryabhata** - Aryabhatiya; **Varahamihira** - Brihat Samhita; **Kalidasa** - Meghaduta and Shakuntalam.
- Writing that the Guptas ruled from Delhi; their capital was **Pataliputra**.
- Naming the invaders who hastened the Gupta decline wrongly; they were the **Hunas** from Central Asia.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 8: **The Gupta Era** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** calm and graceful figures	Classical style
2	**(c)** revenue and prosperity	Economic strength
3	**(b)** to check bias and fill gaps	Cross-checking
4	**(c)** Jataka tales and life of the Buddha	Buddhist stories
5	**(a)** they show wealth and trade	Economy
6	**(a)** royal women could exercise power	Women in politics
7	**(d)** high learning and royal patronage	Reputation
8	**(a)** Kalidasa's works and Faxian	Sources
9	**(d)** secure the southern frontier	Marriage alliance
10	**(b)** they were skilled horsemen invading from Central Asia	Invaders

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Rewarded officials (1); Spread agriculture (1).	1+1
12	Wall paintings (1); At Ajanta (1).	1+1
13	Eye-witness account (1); Social details (1).	1+1
14	Earth rotates (1); Place value (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Conquests (1); Ideals (1); Allies (1).	1+1+1
16	Patronage (1); Temples (1); Tolerance (1).	1+1+1
17	Land tax (1); Guilds (1); Trade (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Sea routes (1); Southeast Asia (1); China and Mediterranean (1).	1+1+1
18	Pilgrim (1); Observation (1); Limits (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Samudragupta (1); Dance (1); Painting (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Prashasti (1); Faxian (1); Coins (1); Cross-checking (1); Limits (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Kalidasa (1); Nalanda (1); Grammar (1); Science (1); Patronage (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Mathematics (1); Astronomy (1); Medicine (1); Metallurgy (1); Impact (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Prabhavati (1); Education (1); Customs (1); Occupations (1); Evidence (1).	1+1+1+1+1

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 8: **The Gupta Era** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** merchants and rulers valued merit	Patronage
2	**(a)** agriculture and trade	Economy
3	**(a)** they weakened central control	Fragmentation
4	**(a)** beginning of structural temples	Deogarh
5	**(a)** to reward officials and support religion	Administrative practice
6	**(c)** achievements set standards for later ages	Cultural peak
7	**(a)** one who binds the earth under his rule	Ambition of Samudragupta
8	**(c)** day and night	Astronomy
9	**(d)** Shakuntalam	Kalidasa
10	**(a)** it shows classical achievements in science and arts	Heritage

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Compare accounts (1); Check bias (1).	1+1
12	Regent (1); Link with Vakatakas (1).	1+1
13	Learning (1); Foreign students (1).	1+1
14	Prestige (1); Faith (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Aryabhata (1); Varahamihira (1); Medicine (1).	1+1+1
16	Huns (1); Local powers (1); Weak rulers (1).	1+1+1
17	North India (1); Eastern coast (1); Allies (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Sarnath (1); Ajanta (1); Style (1).	1+1+1
18	Vakatakas in the Deccan (1); Pallavas in the south (1); Cultural role (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Zero (1); Decimal (1); Astronomy (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Temples (1); Sculpture (1); Murals (1); Caves (1); Features (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Who (1); Places (1); Society (1); Government (1); Limitations (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Agriculture (1); Crafts (1); Trade routes (1); Coins (1); Revenue (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Administration (1); Religion (1); Economy (1); Art (1); Conclusion (1).	1+1+1+1+1

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